

SONNY STEELE

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SUMMARY

Senior product designer who also writes code. I've built across Fortune 500 banks, healthcare, and AI startups, and these days I work as a designer-engineer — shipping production code, not just specs. Solo-built ScoutAI on Next.js, TypeScript, the Claude API, and a Chrome extension. My work has driven \$60M+ in revenue, lifted adoption 35%, and stopped 92% of system failures before they hit. I own the full stack: design system, frontend, API integration, and product strategy.

EXPERIENCE

UX Design Director & Principal AI/ML Consultant — Self-Employed

Jan 2024 – Present

Design-and-build work for enterprise AI companies. I run design strategy and ship the production code that comes with it. In this stretch I founded ScoutAI, led design for Spectra, and worked on five other AI apps.

PROJECTS COMPLETED

Founder & Lead Designer-Engineer — ScoutAI

AI job-search platform. Agents scan 51 job boards daily, score each role against a user's resume and the live market, and flag ghost listings with a 16-signal Reality Score.

- Built and shipped the whole platform solo — Next.js 15, TypeScript, the Claude Sonnet API, Prisma/Postgres on Neon, a Playwright worker on Railway, and a Chrome extension (Manifest V3).
- Built AI agents that parse each resume and compare it against a market database of job descriptions and required skills, then score how well a person fits each role.
- Designed and built the Reality Score — a 16-signal check rating each listing on ATS link health, posting age, salary clarity, and 13 more, so ghost jobs get filtered before they reach the user.

Lead Designer-Engineer — Spectra

AI platform for smart-home and low-voltage AV installers. A user uploads a floor plan, AI lays out the devices, and that feeds wiring diagrams, proposals, and install schedules — all in one place.

- Designed the full product for iPad and desktop: sign-in, dashboard, project hub, equipment specs, floor plans, schedule, and payments.
- Built the brand and design system from scratch — colors, type, components, and tokens. Gave a polished SaaS feel to a trade still run on clipboards and spreadsheets.
- Designed the AI floor-plan flow: upload a plan, AI places the devices, and the output feeds straight into wiring diagrams and proposals.

Principal AI Designer-Engineer — Humanyze

Competitive-intelligence platform for marketing directors and C-suite at Fortune 500 brands.

- Redesigned the core analytics interface and data-viz strategy. Pulled millions of social data points into one clear view built for executives.
- Built sentiment dashboards that cut analysis time for marketing directors. Presented the findings straight to the C-suite.
- Shipped a React-ready component library with full token coverage. Worked with engineering to land the patterns in production on the first pass.

Lead Designer & Front-End Engineer — Kasisto

Conversational AI platform behind digital assistants at Fortune 500 banks — 50M+ customer interactions a month across 4 product lines.

- Lifted platform adoption 35% by running the UX roadmap across 4 product lines and getting stakeholders aligned on one design strategy.
- Cut ML setup time from 3 weeks to 2 days by redesigning the training tools for non-technical bankers. Made the ROI case to execs.
- Built real-time dashboards for 200+ banking use cases. Defined the data contracts, ML inputs, and edge cases with engineering.

Lead UX Designer, AI Monitoring — Ottermon AI

Jan 2024 – Jan 2025

AI monitoring platform for infrastructure and DevOps teams. Designed UX for anomaly detection and predictive-failure systems across 15+ modules.

- Designed the anomaly-detection UI that caught 92% of system failures before they hit. Aligned DevOps and infra teams on alert thresholds and responses.
- Built dashboards that cut mean time to resolution in half. The information architecture surfaced the signal in dense operational data.
- Prototyped model-training tools with ML engineers — parameter controls, threshold views, and feedback loops for custom anomaly detection.

Senior UX Manager — HealthCare.com

2022 – 2024

AI healthcare platform that matches people with health and supplemental insurance using ML personalization and real-time health scoring.

- Led design of an AI recommendation platform that cut decision time 40% and user costs 25%. Got product, data science, and engineering on one health-scoring strategy.
- Designed the ML health-scoring with the data science team — model inputs, feature weighting, and threshold tuning that fed the recommendation engine.
- Raised preventive-care engagement 35% with interfaces that flagged risks and suggested next steps.

Senior UX Director — FCP Euro

2020 – 2022

E-commerce platform for European car enthusiasts — 350,000+ genuine and performance parts. Built the UX function from the ground up.

- Added \$6M in yearly revenue by lifting conversion 5% in three months. It came from a ground-up redesign of how people find parts.
- Cut support calls 45% with UI fixes based on call-center data.
- Built the UX team from scratch — processes, tooling, and standards across the company.

Senior UX Design Manager — Wayfair

2018 – 2020

Led UX for CastleGate, Wayfair's \$2B+ logistics platform covering ocean freight, drayage, and last-mile delivery.

- Saved \$16M in operating costs. The system design cut supplier time-on-task by 8 hours a day across thousands of suppliers.
- Cut customer-success manager time-on-task by 18 hours a week with an information-architecture redesign.
- Managed 5 cross-functional pods (3 designers, 1 writer, 1 PM each). Coached 2 people off performance plans.

Principal UX Designer — Hexaware Technologies

2011 – 2018

UX design lead for Fortune 500 clients across healthcare, retail, fitness, and media.

- Raised Panera Bread mobile orders 40% with a menu and customization flow built mobile-first.
- Designed the Weight Watchers wellness platform for millions of users, with personalized nutrition tracking and community features.
- Built platforms for Wawa, Comcast Tech Nucleus, Reebok ONE, and Weather Channel across retail POS, enterprise tech, fitness wearables, and media.

SKILLS

Design & Strategy: 0→1 product design, product strategy, design systems strategy, DesignOps, design-org strategy, information architecture, interaction design, prototyping, wireframing, stakeholder management

AI Product: conversational AI, multi-modal interfaces, prompt/response UX, AI-powered analytics, large-dataset visualization, analytics dashboards

Build: Next.js + TypeScript, Prisma/Postgres, Playwright, Chrome Extensions (MV3), Claude API + prompt engineering

Research & Accessibility: user research, usability testing, design thinking, WCAG / ADA

Tools: Figma, Cursor, Claude